

Denver ‘Rips’ Aeros But Jim Doesn’t Panic

Special to The Beacon

DENVER, Colo. — One year after Wichita first became a member of the American Association, Andy Cohen was the Indianapolis manager and Ralph Houk managed the Denver Bears. This was in 1957.

"I sure hope we can really rip them in the first game of the series," Houk used to say whenever Indianapolis was coming to the Mile High City to play his Bears.

"If we can score a lot of runs in the first game, Cohen will panic and tear up his pitching staff and we'll have a good chance to sweep the series."

SUNDAY AFTERNOON Wichita's Jim Marshall was managing the visiting ball club in Denver's home park for the first time. He came face-to-face with the problems Cohen used to face when he brought Indianapolis to town. In fact, he faced them to about as acute a degree as one could imagine.

But no one could say he panicked. If anything, one might be tempted to say he reacted the other way. He was so determined to stay with his pitchers rather than parade his staff in and out of the combat area that he allowed at least one of them to absorb almost superhuman punishment and the other two to suffer exceptional indignities.

He did accomplish one thing, however: He used only three pitchers in taking a 21-10 beating. He must have figured a loss is a loss is a loss and there's no use throwing good money after bad.

The breezy, 82-degree afternoon started out auspiciously for the Western Division leaders as Frank Coggins lined a wicked two-run homer into the right-field stands in the first inning.

BUT THE BEARS, after warning starter Floyd Weaver of their intentions with two squandered hits in the first inning, bombed him in the next two innings in which they scored three runs apiece. In the process they got a homer (No. 5) and a two-run triple from Don Castle, a couple of doubles (one by the pitcher), a single, and three walks.

Two line drives were caught, one apparently "sure" homer was kept in the park by a gusty 15-mile-an-hour wind blowing from left to right. Two innings later the Bears wasted two more hits and had another "homer" beaten back by the wind.

Through all of this bombardment, Marshall, scarcely flicked an eyelash. He didn't even warm up a pitcher until the Bears had six runs in with two out in the third, and then only briefly. When he finally did remove Weaver, it was for a pinch-hitter in the sixth during which the Aeros scored six runs to take an 8-6 lead with the help of three solid blows, three scratch hits, and a pair of walks with the bases loaded.

RON TOMPKINS, however, partly

WICHITA					DENVER				
ab	r	h	r	h	ab	r	h	r	h
Ortiz rf	5	1	2	3	Mason ss	6	2	3	3
James cf	5	1	1	1	Ragland 2b	6	0	0	3
Coggins 2b	4	2	3	3	Jones cf	7	3	4	4
Bourque 1b	4	0	1	1	Harrison 1b	6	2	2	2
Blanco if	4	1	2	3	Fahey c	2	1	0	1
Hughes 3b	5	2	3	3	Wash if	2	1	0	1
Hibbs c	5	2	3	3	Patterson ph-if	2	1	1	1
Rosello ss	5	2	3	3	Ralliff pr-if	5	4	3	3
Weaver p	2	0	0	0	Castle rf	5	2	2	2
Porter ph	1	0	1	1	Greenberg 2b	5	2	2	2
Tompkins p	0	0	0	0	Brown p	3	1	3	3
Rickey ph-p	2	0	1	1	Miles p	0	0	0	0
					Wachemehl p	0	0	0	0
					Kelley p	0	0	0	0
					Stelmastek ph	0	0	0	0
					Carlos p	2	0	0	0
Totals	42	10	17	17	Totals	47	21	22	22

Wichita	200	066	101	—10
Denver	033	085	82	—21

E—Coggins, Hughes, Rosello, Fahey, DP — Denver 2, LOB—Wichita 10, Denver 12, RBI—Ortiz 2, James, Coggins 3, Hughes, Gibbs, Rosello 2, Mason 4, Jones, Harrison 3, Patterson 2, Castle 4, Greenberg 4, Brown, Stelmastek.

2B — James, Mason 2, Harrison, Castle, Brown, 3B—Jones, Castle, HR — Coggins (3), Harrison (1), Castle (3), Greenberg (3), SF — Mason.

	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO
Weaver	5	10	6	6	3	7
Tompkins (L, 1-1)	1	2	5	5	3	0
Rickey	2	10	10	7	2	3
Brown	3	7	6	6	1	7
Miles	0	3	2	2	1	0
Wachemehl	0	0	0	0	1	0
Kelley	1	0	0	0	0	0
Carlos (W, 3-1)	3	7	2	2	0	1
HBP — by Carlos (Coggins), WP — Weaver 2, Brown, T—3:16, A—5:47.						

Aeros Statistics

(Unofficial through Sunday)

HITTING									
AB	R	H	HR	RBI	AVG	AB	R	H	HR
Porter	31	9	10	0	.323				
Bourque	108	21	34	8	.215				
James	129	18	39	3	.202				
Rosello	110	16	22	0	.191				
Hughes	99	15	24	3	.267				
Montroull	15	4	4	0	.267				
Blanco	117	19	31	3	.265				
Saul	4	1	1	1	.250				
Coggins	132	14	23	3	.250				
Hibbs	53	10	13	1	.245				
Ortiz	86	15	17	0	.198				
Bredon	47	5	9	2	.191				

PITCHING									
W-L	IP	ER	BB	SO	ERA	W-L	IP	ER	BB
Decker	4-0	45	7	17	1.40				
R. Reuschel	5-1	60.2	12	13	1.80				
Tompkins	1-1	13.2	3	13	2.05				
Bonham	5-1	46.2	14	10	2.74				
Gura	1-2	16.2	5	4	2.81				
Todd	2-1	20	11	14	3.09				
Rodriguez	1-1	22	9	6	3.68				
Weaver	0-1	13	12	6	8.36				
Rickey	2-2	12.2	12	11	8.65				

because of an error on a double-play ball by shortstop Dave Rosello with one on and one out, and partly because of two bases-full walks after two intentional passes, was touched for five runs in the Denver half of the sixth. So the Aeros gained only one run on the Bears in the inning which lasted a full hour.

And what happened to Ralph Rickey in the seventh was downright brutal. The Bears battered him for eight runs on seven hits, got two more runs in the eighth, and had two more hits before Rickey finally got 'em out. Through it all, Marshall decided to let Rickey take all the punishment.

The Aeros, who lost only four games in the first four and a half weeks of the campaign, now have lost five in one week as their 9½ game lead is down to seven.

But at least Marshall's pitching staff was not torn up despite Denver's 22-hit assault good for 40 total bases. The Aeros have Joe Decker (4-0), Rick Reuschel (5-1) and Bill Bonham (4-1) for the last three games of the series. And that's a whole lot better than the Bears have to offer. They have Mike Tompkins (2-2) for tonight, then it's anybody's guess.